

StarShot Prototype

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1. Game Overview

In the distant future pirate crews sail the solar winds in Sunjammers, roaming between cryptic treasure worlds. They scrap for ancient weapons and dogfight in the void. But only one can earn the title of **Bosa Sennen**, the most feared pirate in the system.

StarShot is a competitive tactical space combat game for 2–4 players. Each round, players secretly prepare three Action stacks for their ship, then reveal and execute those Actions to maneuver their ships, attack opponents, and collect treasure.

The game is played over six rounds, or until only one ship remains. After round six, if more than one player is still alive, the player with the most Victory Points (VP) wins. Players may play on teams, with each player piloting their own ship and sharing common Victory Points with their team.

2. Components

Common game pieces:

- 1 Hex-based Space board approximately 12 hexes in radius
- 10 Bauble round number tokens
- 1 Round and Bauble Track
- 1 Desperation card deck
- 30 One Victory Point tokens
- 15 Five Victory Point tokens
- 60 Ship damage/shield charge markers

Per-player game pieces:

- 1 Starship token
- 1 Orders deck
- 1 Set of 3 Sealed Orders cards in their color
- 1 Starship layout board with Deck, Overheat, and Victory Point areas
- 2 Twelve-sided dice

3. Setup

1. Place the Space board in reach of all players, and place each player's ship token in its matching color starting tile, facing the center of the board.
2. Shuffle the Bauble Round tokens and place them randomly on the 10 red Baubles scattered around the Space board, number side up. Do not place a Round token on The Fang, which is the central Bauble.
3. Set the Round and Bauble track to Round 1 and place it in view of all players.
4. Set the Victory Point tokens in reach of all players.
5. Shuffle the Desperation deck, and place it next to the Space board with the Desperately Reshuffle card on top. Desperation cards are drawn from the bottom of the deck.

- Distribute to each player the color-matched set of 3 Sealed Orders cards, Starship board, and two twelve-sided dice (“d12” dice) matching their token.
- Distribute an Orders deck to each player. It should consist of 5 Move cards and 3 Attack cards. Note the Orders deck does not have the distinctive Desperation markings on its Attack cards.
- Choose the starting player by rolling d12’s. The player with the highest roll is the starting player.

Orders Deck

Quantity	Card Type
2	Move 1
3	Move 2
2	Targeted Attack 1
1	Targeted Attack 2

4.Round Structure

StarShot is played over a series of rounds. Each round follows the same sequence:

- Give Orders
- Cooldown
- Action 1
- Action 2
- Action 3
- Award Baubles
- Cleanup

Once Cleanup is complete, advance the Round Tracker, rotate the Starting Player designation clockwise, and begin the next round.

Give Orders

Each player secretly prepares three Action stacks - **Action 1**, **Action 2**, and **Action 3**. These will be executed in sequence, with each player performing each Action step before advancing to the next.

To create each of the three Action stacks:

- Choose up to two Command cards from your deck with the same type (Move or Attack).
- The Face (Front or Back) and Orientation (Up or Down) are important and cannot be changed after Orders are issued.
- Cover the stack with the matching **Sealed** card corresponding to the Action number, placing the **Sealed** card either “Sealed” face up or “Overdrive” face up.

After all three Action stacks have been prepared, return all unused Command cards to your Deck. When every player has finished giving orders and Sealed their Action stacks, the round begins.

Cooldown

After Orders are sealed, return every card in your **Overheated** stack to your Deck. These cards are now available to use when resolving this round's Actions.

Resolve Actions

The three Action stacks are resolved one at a time, beginning with **Action 1** and ending with **Action 3**.

For each Action:

1. Every player reveals their matching Action stack.
2. All Movement cards are resolved simultaneously. Moves execute in their stacked order.
3. The Combat stage takes place, beginning with the starting player and continuing clockwise.
4. After the Action is complete, place the executed cards into the appropriate area:
 - a. Normally Sealed Command cards return to the player's Deck
 - b. Overdriven Command cards go to the player's Overheat stack
 - c. Desperation cards played with their Desperate face return to the common Desperation deck

After Action 3 has been completed, proceed to Awarding Baubles.

Award Baubles

If a player's ship is in a red Bauble circle on the Space board corresponding to the current round or within The Fang's circle in the center, award them the appropriate Victory Points and/or Desperation cards.

Cleanup

Complete the following steps in order:

1. Resolve any effects that occur during Cleanup.
2. Advance the Round Tracker.

Then begin the next round.

5. Ending the Game

At the completion of a Round, if only one player's ship is not destroyed, that player wins the game. If all ships are destroyed, the game is a tie.

Otherwise, at the completion of Round 6 the game ends, and the player with the most Victory Points wins. In case of a tie, the player with the most destroyed ship components wins. If it is still a tie, talk like a pirate for the next game.

Variant Rule: The Void Beckons

If a player's ship is destroyed before round 6, they may rejoin the game at the beginning of the next round with no VP and their original deck and intact ship, as though they had just begun the game. Alternatively, they may

choose to remain eliminated and keep their VP. In this variant, the winner is determined solely by Victory Points, and not by last-ship-standing.

6. Cards

There are two types of cards: Command Cards and Sealed Cards.

Command Cards

Command cards represent the standard activities of the captain and the crew, as they move about the system and attack their foes.

Each player begins with 8 Base Command Cards in their deck. Additionally, players may gain Desperation Command Cards (aka Desperation Cards) from the Desperation deck throughout the course of the game. Regardless, all Command Cards are used to generate Action stacks during the Give Orders step of a round. Recall that Action stacks may only contain 1 or 2 cards, and those cards must be of the same type - either Attack or Move.

Base Deck Cards

Targeted Attack

A Targeted Attack features the red text "Target <X>" where X is a number, written on both faces. Additionally, these cards have 4 colored arrows, 1 in each orientation on each face.

To play this card, place it in an Action stack when giving orders, and choose a face and orientation so that your attack target's color is facing upwards on the top face of the card.

A Targeted Attack's effect can be enhanced by playing it in conjunction with another Targeted Attack or a Desperate Attack to create a **Volley** - one attack which targets one enemy player but deals additional damage. If combined with a second Targeted Attack, both cards must target the same opponent. If two Targeted Attacks are combined this way, their resulting Volley's damage is equal to their sum.

<Targeted Attack Card image>

<Volley definition / diagram>

Desperate Targeted Attacks

Note that in addition to the base deck's Targeted Attacks, the Desperation card deck contains additional Targeted Attacks, although its cards are marked with the distinctive Desperation markings to distinguish them from base deck cards. Unlike the base deck Targeted Attacks, cards from the Desperation deck do not benefit from Overdrive.

Controlled Move

A Controlled Move features green text "Move <X>" where X is a number, written on both faces. Additionally, these cards have 4 different arrows, 1 in each orientation on each face.

To play this card, place it in an Action stack and choose a face and orientation so that your desired direction is facing upwards on the top face of the card. The face and orientation provides the following options:

- Move forward <X> hexes
- U-Turn (face the opposite direction)
- Move forward <X> hexes and then rotate right one hex face (1/6 turn)

- Move forward <X> hexes and then rotate left one hex face (1/6 turn)

A Controlled Move's effect can be chained by playing it in conjunction with another Controlled Move. If combined with a second Move Card, the Action will result in first carrying out the Move of the top card, and then the move of the second card.

<For example: Movement card following diagram>

Desperation Deck Cards

Desperation cards represent the heroism of the captain and crew in the stress of battle. While the ship may be operating at reduced functionality, in moments of pressure they can accomplish incredible feats.

Drawing a Desperation Card

Desperation cards are gained when specified by other mechanics. When you gain a Desperation card, draw from the bottom of the Desperation deck so you cannot see either face before drawing it. When you discard a Desperation card, place it on top of the Desperation deck. If you draw the "Shuffle Desperately" card, that indicates the deck has been entirely drawn and needs to be reshuffled, with the "Shuffle Desperately" card returned to the top afterwards.

Desperation Cards Types and Appearance

The Desperation Deck cards have distinctive dash marks at the corners. There are a few Desperate Targeted Attack cards. However the majority of Desperation cards have two faces, a Basic face and a Desperate face, showing the reduced ship functionality and insane genius under fire.

Desperation Card's Basic Faces

The Basic face has either "Move 1", or both "Attack 1" and "Move 1" in up and down orientations. Thus Basic card faces may be a Basic Move in one orientation and a Basic Attack card face in the other orientation.

<Figure of the two Desperation card faces>

Basic Moves

The Basic Move face has the green "Move" text followed by a number. A Basic Move has no Turn or U-turn arrows, so it only moves the player ship forwards. Like a Controlled Move, it can be combined with another Move card to move the ship multiple times with the same action. It can be used without a Controlled Move, either alone or with any other type of Move. Moves are carried out in the order the cards are stacked in the action.

Basic Attack

The Basic Attack has the red "Attack" text followed by a number. Unlike a Targeted Attack, a Basic Attack card has no targeting arrows that would allow it to designate a target, so it must be combined with a Targeted Attack. When combined this way, the **Volley's** damage is the sum of the Targeted Attack card and Basic Attack card.

Desperation Card's Desperate Faces

The Desperate face of each Desperation card represents a heroic feat of skill and engineering by the captain and his crew, and it pushes the ship beyond its limits. Normally, when a Command card's actions are

complete, it is placed back into the deck for next turn, or the Overdrive stack if so ordered. However when a Desperate ability is used, the Desperation card is returned to the Desperation deck instead of the player's deck or Overheat stack - pushing your ship and crew this far has a cost.

The Desperate face is identified by an underlined skill name in the center, and will be a red Desperate Attack Mod, a green Desperate Move, or an orange Especially Desperate Ability.

Desperate Attack Mod

A Desperate Attack Mod, is similar to a Basic Attack - it is untargeted and must be combined with a Targeted Attack to take effect. Desperate Attack Mods use several terms:

- “+X Aim” or “+X to Hit”: After making your **Volley's** attack roll, add X to your roll to aid in hitting the enemy.
- “+X Damage”: If the **Volley** hits, it deals an additional X damage to the enemy.

<Steady Shot: +2 Aim, +1 Damage>

Desperate Move

A Desperate Move can be played on its own or in the same Action as another Move card. Desperate Move cards use several terms:

- “+X Defense”: Increase the Hit threshold of attackers against you during this Action by X.
- “Warp”: Move your ship to the designated tile. Do not change facing, and do not apply the Warp distance as movement for the purposes of attacks against you this Action.

<Homeward Bound: Warp to Home, +5 Defense>

Especially Desperate

Especially Desperate card faces are neither Attacks nor Moves, and are not placed in Action stacks like normal Commands. After using the Especially Desperate face, return the card to the Desperation Deck. They are played directly from your deck, and cannot be played if they somehow become Overheated.

Currently there are 2 types:

- “Restore X Components”: Choose X tiles of your ship that have been destroyed, where each is adjacent to an intact tile. Restore the chosen tiles to an undamaged state.
These are played directly from your deck during the Cleanup step
- “Overdrive 3, Bonus +2”: Use this instead of your normally “Overdrive 3” card to Seal your 3rd Action. When sealed with this card, that Action stack gains a bonus of +2 instead of the normal +1. Play this directly from your deck when Sealing orders.

<Hull Repair: Restore 1 Component>

Sealed / Overdrive Cards

Each player has 3 cards featuring the text “Sealed X” on one face and “Overdrive X” on the other face, for X's values 1, 2, and 3. These cards are used to Seal their orders, indicating they are prepared to begin the round. When an Action stack is Sealed with the “Sealed” side, that Action stack functions normally.

However if an Action stack is Sealed with the “Overdrive” side, the effects of base deck cards in the stack are enhanced, but at a cost.

When the base deck's Move or Attack cards are Sealed with an “Overdrive” card, increase their effects by 1. Thus a Move 2 becomes a Move 3, an Attack 1 becomes an Attack 2, etc. Turning and U-turning are not

affected. When a card is boosted by Overdrive, the ship's systems become depleted. At the end of that Action step, move the Overdriven cards into the Overheat pile instead of into your deck, they will need 1 round to cool off before being available again.

Overdrive does not apply to Desperation Cards. Their values are not increased and they are not placed in the Overheat deck if their pile is Overheated.

7. Combat Stage

In the Action step after all moves have been executed, if there are any Attacks being played, each attacker executes their **Volley** of Attack cards by performing the Attack Roll, and then potentially a Shield Check and Damage Roll. The Starting Player completes these, followed by each other attacker in clockwise order. Each player makes only 1 attack in an Action, targeting the ship designated by the Targeted Attack card(s) in the orders.

Determine the Volley

A **Volley** is an attempt to hit the enemy for one or more damage, and is formed when giving Orders by placing one or more Attack cards in the stack. For example, a base deck's Attack 2 card forms a Volley with no Aim bonus and 2 damage. When multiple Attack cards are combined, the **Volley** potentially gains Aim bonus and/or additional damage. Add together all Aim bonuses and sum all damage to find the final Aim bonus and total damage that could be dealt. Note that multiple Attack cards, even Targeted Attacks, do not create more than one Volley or more than one Attack Roll.

<Example figure of a one-card Volley and a two-card Volley>

Attack Roll

Start by identifying the target of the Attack. Measure the distance in hexes from the attacker to their target starting with the first empty hex adjacent to the attacker and ending on the target's hex. Take that distance and add the total movement executed by the target earlier this action. If the defender has a Defense bonus, add it to that total. The result is the Final Defense value you need to hit.

Then roll 2d12 (2 twelve-sided dice) and add any Aim bonuses. If the result is equal or greater than the Final Defense, the **Volley** attack is a Hit!

<Figure for Distance + Move = Target Roll>

Shields and Damage

If a ship would be hit by a **Volley**, it can be blocked by Shields. Ships begin with 2 shield charges. If the ship would take damage while shield charges remain, the Shield generator activates, protecting the ship from all incoming damage for the rest of that step (ie. against all attackers' **Volleys**), and expending one shield charge. One Shield generator activation prevents all damage across that entire Action step, regardless of source or amount. Striking an active Shield generates one VP for the attacker regardless of the size of the **Volley**, or whether the player triggered the Shield activation or hit the triggered Shield later in that Action step.

Unshielded Hits

Once all shield charges are expended, hits damage the ship structure itself, with every shot of the volley potentially causing destruction. When a player hits an unshielded enemy ship, the attacker gains one Victory Point if at least one component is destroyed, or three if the **Volley** results in total ship destruction. Note that it

is possible to score a hit but not strike any components if the ship is sufficiently damaged that the shot passes through it, resulting in no VP being awarded. Destroying multiple components in the same Volley does not grant additional VP's.

Gaining Desperation Under Attack

When the hits start coming the defender's ship loses capability but the crew gains that edge of desperation. The first time a ship component is destroyed by a given **Volley**, the defender must choose one of the following:

1. Move a card from their Deck to their Overheat stack
2. Remove a Base deck card in their Deck from the game, and place a random Desperation card in their deck.
3. Remove a Base deck card in their Overheat stack from the game, and place a random Desperation card in their Overheat stack.

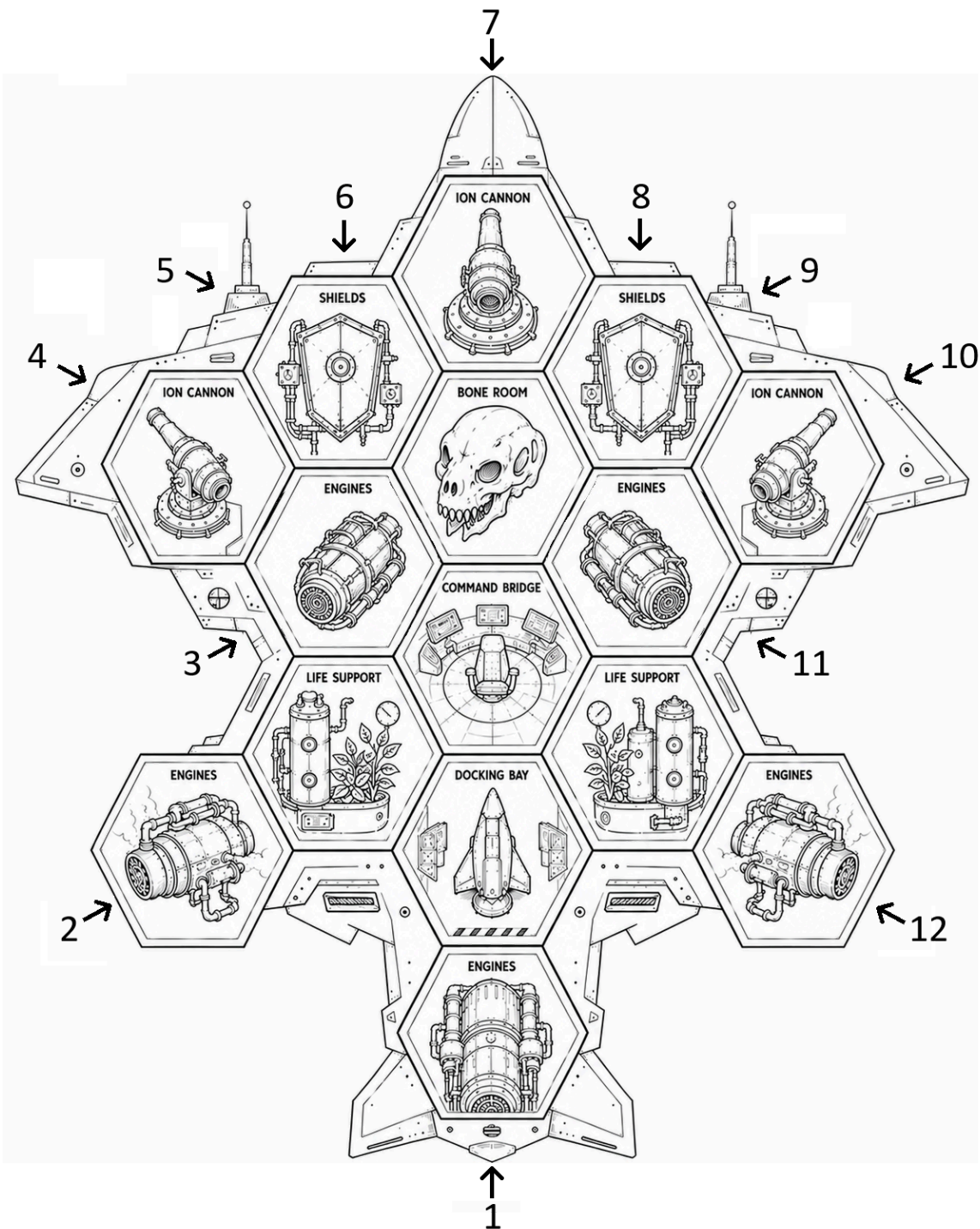
Note that you cannot replace a Desperation card with another Desperation card.

If a player has somehow reached the position where all cards in their deck and Overheat stack are gone or are Desperation cards, that player loses 1 VP instead.

Damage Location

For each shot within the **Volley**, roll 1d12 to determine the lane where the hit occurs. Once the incoming shot's lane is chosen, it destroys the first component in the lane, passing through tiles where components are already destroyed. Consequently, damage can reach the Bridge by after components blocking access are destroyed.

Ship Diagram



Ship Destruction

If a ship suffers enough damage, it can be destroyed. Losing any of the following groups is lethal.

1. The Bridge
2. Both Life Supports
3. All Coilguns and All Ion Engines

If an attacker eliminates the ship entirely, such as by destroying the Bridge, the attacker gains 3 VP instead of the normal 1 for the **Volley**. Note that any attacks in the current Action ordered by a ship before it was eliminated still take effect - all ships had a chance to fire their weapons before shots began to hit.

8. Baubles

Scattered across the Congregation are Baubles, small worlds veiled in a shield of glimmering energy. But very rarely, the shield dissipates for mere hours, and a timely crew can find ancient treasures. Across the map are 11 baubles, two each randomly numbered 1 through 5 and a final Bauble for round 6 named **The Fang**. At the end of each round, the matching numbered Baubles open, and any crew that is within 1 tile of it may reap the rewards.

During the Award Baubles step, if you are within 1 tile of the Bauble that matches the round number, you gain Victory Points points as shown on the Bauble track, and you draw a card from the Desperation deck.

The final Bauble is **The Fang**. Its riches are legendary but deadly. During the Award Baubles step if you are within 1 tile of the **The Fang**, gain 1 VP and take 1 damage (roll one time for all ships). This damage can be absorbed by a shield activation, and never triggers Overheating cards or gaining Desperation cards. Round 6 rewards 6 VP and deals 1 damage.

Bauble Round Point Progression

Round	1	2	3	4	5	6
Point Value	4	3	3	4	4	6

9. Victory Points

Victory Points (VP) are the primary mark of success for a captain. They are gained in the following methods:

1. Attacking an enemy ship and hitting their Shields with a **Volley** (1 VP).
2. Destroying at least one ship component with a **Volley** (1 VP).
3. Getting the kill shot on an enemy ship (3 VP instead of 1 from the **Volley**).
4. Breaching a Bauble on the round it is open (Varies per Bauble).

10. Card Listing

Base Orders Decks

#	Type	Details
2	Controlled Move 1	Has Straight, Turn, and U-Turn arrows
3	Controlled Move 2	Has Straight, Turn, and U-Turn arrows
2	Targeted Attack 1	Has Targeting colors
1	Targeted Attack 2	Has Targeting colors

Desperation Deck

When your ship starts to fall apart, you are at your best! Desperation cards represent the ingenuity of the captain and his crew in the heat of battle. Each Desperation card has a low power reusable face and a high power single-use face.

When used on their single-use side (indicated by an underlined title) they are returned to the Desperation deck. When used on their low power side, they return to your deck as normal.

Desperation cards may not be Overdriven on either face.

Desperation cards come in 3 types:

1. Move 1 Front Face / Desperate Back Face: The move is a Move 1 without a turn
2. Attack 1, Move 1 Front Face / Desperate Back Face: The move is a Move 1 without a turn, and the Attack 1 is a bonus to damage. The Attack 1 orientation has no Targeting and thus must be combined with a normal targeted Attack 1 card to function.
3. Desperate Targeted Attack 1: A duplicate of the normal Attack 1 card with targets in the Base Orders deck, except this one cannot be Overdriven.

The Desperate Targeted Attack cards serve to replenish your deck's ability to target an attack if you are low on normal Attack cards.

#	Desperate Face	Type	Normal Face	Details
2	Thrust Ions	Move	Move 1	Move 5
1	Turbo Ions	Move	Move 1	Move 10
1	Homeward Bound	Move	Move 1	Warp Home (+5 Defense)
1	Treasure Hound	Move	Move 1	Warp Bauble (+5 Defense)
1	Evasive Action	Move	Move 1	+10 Defense, Can't Move
2	Ace Shot	Attack	Attack 1 / Move 1	+5 to Hit
1	Deadeye	Attack	Attack 1 / Move 1	An Attack always hits
1	Nightjammer	Attack	Attack 1 / Move 1	Warp Leader (+5 Defense)
1	Self Destruct	Attack	Attack 1 / Move 1	Range 2, Damage 4, Keep VP
1	Death Blossom	Attack	Attack 1 / Move 1	Attack All with Defense 10

2	Steady Shot	Attack	Attack 1 / Move 1	+2 Aim, +1 Damage
1	Hull Repair*	Turn End	Move 1	Restore 1 Component
1	Advanced Repair*	Turn End	Move 1	Restore 2 Components
4	Attack 1 Targeted	Attack	Attack 1 Targeted	Supplements normal Attack 1 cards which may be missing from your deck.
1	All She's Got Overdrive 3 Bonus +1	Overdrive 3	Move 1	Use in place of your Action 3 Sealed/Overdrive card. Grants +2 bonus instead of the usual +1 of an Overdrive.

11. Expansions

Two expansions that add complexity to the game but shouldn't be base include:

1. StarCommand: Adds Pilots/Ships and Starfall events. These modify each player's basic abilities and generate random effects at the start of each round.
2. StarTech: Adds Engineering cards, a 3rd type. Engineering cards often have ongoing effects that aren't directly moving or damage.

StarCommand

The “StarCommand” expansion adds unique Sunjammer Captains and random Starfall system-wide events.

Sunjammer Captains

At the beginning of the game, each player chooses a Captain, which modifies their ship’s operation. Randomly assign the ships, or allow players to choose their favorite. These are printed in 4 cards, with a/b on card 1, c/d on card 2, etc.

Captain List

- a. Malcolm “Sarge” Manderly: Malcolm has +2 to all Attack Rolls
- b. Anya “Fura” Andrews: Anya deals +1 damage but has no Shields
- c. Riley “Turbo” Rounder: Riley has +1 Move from Move cards, but no bonus defense from movement
- d. Danny “Drifter” Davos: Danny moves 2 tiles forward at the beginning of the Cleanup step
- e. Carlos “Danger” Connor: Carlos gains 1 VP whenever he loses a ship component
- f. Knute “Rocky” Knuckle: Knute’s Bridge and Life Support components take 2 hits to destroy.
- g. Beto “Golden” Briego: Beto gains 1 additional VP and 1 additional Desperation card from Baubles
- h. Illyria “Boney” Landow: When the first Starfall event of the round is revealed, if Illyria’s Bone Room is intact she chooses to either gain 1 VP or place the Starfall event on the bottom of the Starfall deck so the next event happens instead.

Starfall Events

Solar storms and cosmic disasters plague the vast expanses of space, causing unpredictable mayhem for all crews alike. Before issuing orders, draw a new Starfall card. Its effect applies immediately to all players and persists through the end of this round’s Cleanup step.

When a Starfall event deals damage, no cards are discarded nor Desperation cards drawn (except by Captain abilities). Shields may absorb the damage unless specified otherwise.

Starfall Deck

- a. Solar Storm: Roll a single damage die. It applies to all players and penetrates shields.
- b. Gravity Burst: Move all ships 2 tiles towards The Fang (the center Bauble).
- c. Clear Skies: All ships roll 3d12 for attacks instead of 2d12 this round.
- d. Stars Align: Roll a d12 and halve the result (round down). The matching round’s Bauble(s) open this round.
- e. Take Cover: At the end of this round, roll 2 damage dice. This damage hits all players outside of a Bauble’s range. Any Bauble provides protection, even if it is not open.
- f. Golden Bounty: This turn, when you hit an enemy ship for the first time during an Action (including hitting Shields), gain 1 additional VP.
- g. Most Dangerous Game: All Baubles open at the end of this turn. Roll 2 damage dice at end of turn, and each player in a Bauble takes that damage.
- h. Sudden Chill: Each player returns 1 Overheated card to their deck before Orders are given. If they can’t, they gain 1 VP. (Cannot be chosen for Round 1’s Starfall event.)